

Beacon Digest -- 2026-09-18

Linux

[\$] Thread-identity switcheroo for io_uring

Source: *LWN.net*

The io_uring subsystem is all about asynchronous execution; applications count on it to not block — unless explicitly requested to. Within io_uring, maintaining the "never blocks" guarantee has sometimes been a challenge, given that many paths in the kernel were never designed for asynchronous execu...

GNOME 51 released

Source: *LWN.net*

Version 51 of the GNOME desktop environment has been released. The list of changes includes a number of performance improvements, offline data and better transit information in the Maps application, a new interface for the file previewer, and more.

Security updates for Thursday

Source: *LWN.net*

Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (.NET 10.0, .NET 8.0, .NET 9.0, corosync, firewalld, kernel, kernel-rt, libevent, libsoup, microcode_ctl, nginx:1.26, python-lxml, rsyslog, tesseract, and unbound), Debian (firefox-esr, mkvtoolnix, thunderbird, and tor), Fedora (open62541, php-pecl-mong...

Friday Five — September 18, 2026 | Red Hat

Source: *Red Hat Blog*

Red Hat Recognized as a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for Server Virtualization PlatformsRed Hat is recognized as a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for Server Virtualization Platforms. In Red Hat's opinion, this recognition reinforces OpenShift's ability to deliver a modern...

From data residency to digital control: Why the Middle East's cloud future depends on the ecosystem

Source: *Red Hat Blog*

For CIOs across the Gulf, the cloud conversation has moved past basic adoption. Governments and enterprises are investing heavily in cloud platforms, artificial

intelligence (AI), and national digital infrastructure. However, the harder questions now sit with those accountable for keeping critical s...

Smart enough, fast enough: Choosing the right models for agentic work

Source: Red Hat Blog

A few weeks ago I was watching a coding agent run through a multistep task, and what stood out was not whether it got the answer right. I found, 9 times out of 10, it did. What stood out to me was the waiting. Every step meant another call to the model, another few thousand tokens of reasoning, anot...

Scaling enterprise AI fleets with Alquimia and Red Hat OpenShift AI

Source: Red Hat Blog

Building an AI agent in a Jupyter Notebook is a solved problem. With a handful of lines of Python and a large language model (LLM) API key, you can wire up a prototype that reads emails, invokes custom tools, and responds to users. It feels like magic. But when an enterprise scales from a single deve...

Omarchy - The Agentic Linux Desktop

Source: Mental Outlaw

In this video I review Omarchy OS and some of the agentic workflows you can perform on it. It's an interesting experience and requires little configuration for AI workflows besides signing into accounts or pasting in API keys but there's also several security concerns with it. My merch is available...

Security

Claimed Bug Bounty Hunter Likely Used LLM to Build PhantomRaven npm Stealer

Source: The Hacker News

A financially motivated threat actor has been linked to the development and distribution of a JavaScript (JS)-based information stealer known as PhantomRaven via the npm package registry. "The developer likely wrote the malware using a large language model (LLM), an assessment made with high confide...

RatHat Android Malware Abuses ADB to Retain Shell Access After Uninstall

Source: The Hacker News

Cybersecurity researchers have flagged a new Android malware called RatHat that's assessed to be operated by China-based threat actors and features an artificial intelligence (AI)-powered system to navigate and control compromised devices. "Distributed primarily via targeted smishing (SMS/text phish...

Critical Check Point Management Flaw Lets Unauthenticated Attackers Run Code as Root

Source: The Hacker News

A critical vulnerability in Check Point's Security Management and Log Servers could allow an attacker without login credentials to run code as root on those servers over the network. The Security Management Server is the system that controls firewall policy and administrator access. Check Point has...

ThreatsDay: Self-Rewriting Agents, 800+ Flaws Patched, Insider SIM Swaps and 22 More New Stories

Source: The Hacker News

Attackers keep finding new keys. The funny part is that defenders keep inventing where to store them. This week, those keys sit in AI tools, exposed services, old bugs, weak logins, and software sold like a monthly subscription. Some attacks use new tricks. Others just reuse what was already lying a...

Critical Docker Sandboxes Flaw Lets Malicious Guest Code Read and Modify macOS Host Files

Source: The Hacker News

Malicious code running inside a Docker Sandboxes virtual machine on macOS could escape the project directory shared into it and read or change files anywhere else on the host, Docker warns in a security announcement on September 15. The escape runs with the rights of the host account that runs the v...

Iran-Linked Handala Hack Tied to HEAVYGRAM Telegram Backdoor That Can Steal Passwords

Source: The Hacker News

The Iran-linked "hacktivist" persona known as Handala Hack has been attributed to a Telegram-based surveillance backdoor called HEAVYGRAM and a Delphi-based utility known as CRUDEEXCLUDE. "HEAVYGRAM offers builtin commands supporting remote command execution, system, network and process information...

Critical Unbound DNSSEC Validator Flaw Could Allow RCE via a Malicious DNS Zone

Source: The Hacker News

Every release of the Unbound DNS resolver before 1.26.1 has a critical heap overflow in its DNSSEC validator, maintainer NLnet Labs said in an advisory on Wednesday. An attacker who controls a malicious zone and queries a vulnerable resolver can trigger it, enabling remote code execution. Unbound 1....

Can You Prove a New CVE Is Exploitable Before Attackers Do? Learn How in This Webinar

Source: The Hacker News

A new CVE drops. Your scanner finds it. The severity score looks ugly. But that still does not answer the question that matters: Can it actually be exploited in your environment? Mythos-class AI is compressing the time between disclosure and working exploitation, while many security programs still v...

CISO's Expert Guide to Agentic Pentesting for Websites

Source: The Hacker News

Attackers now weaponize new vulnerabilities in about five days (Mandiant, part of Google Cloud). The median organization takes 43 days to patch one (Verizon DBIR 2026). A new free guide explains how autonomous AI agents are closing that gap, and what security leaders must demand before pointing one...

China-Aligned FamousSparrow Deploys SparroWocky Backdoor Across Latin America

Source: The Hacker News

The China-aligned state-sponsored threat actor known as FamousSparrow has been observed deploying a previously unreported backdoor called SparroWocky in attacks targeting multiple countries in Latin America since at least August 2025. "SparroWocky is a modular, C++ backdoor," ESET security researche...

OpenAI Reveals Six Model Incidents Involving Hidden Failures and Unauthorized Uploads

Source: The Hacker News

OpenAI on Wednesday disclosed six new instances of "unexpected or concerning model behavior" that took place over the past six months, while sharing a new framework for reporting, tracking, investigating, and disclosing model misalignment in a bid to improve transparency. "As AI systems grow more ad...

BIND 9 Update Fixes 14 Flaws, Including an Unauthenticated Crash Over DNS-over-HTTPS

Source: The Hacker News

The Internet Systems Consortium (ISC) has released BIND 9.20.29 and 9.21.26 to fix fourteen security flaws it disclosed on 16 September in BIND 9, its open-source DNS server software. One of them affects any BIND server that answers DNS-over-HTTPS (DoH). A sender with no credentials can crash the se...

Gyazo Breach Exposes 23.62 Million User Records and 490 Million Image Metadata Records

Source: The Hacker News

A security breach at Gyazo, Helpfeel's image-sharing service, exposed about 23.62 million user records, including email addresses and password hashes, the Kyoto-based company said in a notice published Wednesday. It also exposed about 490 million image metadata records, mostly for images from Januar...

Cisco Warns of New Zero-Day ISE Auth Bypass (CVSS 10.0) Exploited in Active Attacks

Source: The Hacker News

Cisco has warned of a fresh maximum-severity security flaw impacting Identity Services Engine (ISE) that has come under active exploitation. The vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-76460 (CVSS score: 10.0), could allow an unauthenticated, remote attacker to bypass authentication. "This vulnerability...

U.S. Seizes NightmareStresser Domains Linked to Hundreds of Thousands of DDoS Attacks

Source: The Hacker News

The U.S. Department of Justice (DoJ) on Tuesday announced the court-authorized seizure of internet domains associated with a distributed denial-of-service (DDoS)-for-hire service known as NightmareStresser. The domains in question are: nightmare-stresser[.]com and nightmarestresser[.]org. Visitors t...

General Tech

Jemalloc 5.4.0

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://github.com/jemalloc/jemalloc/releases/tag/5.4.0> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49750152> Points: 121 # Comments: 34

The scourge of x86 emulation

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://fex-emu.com/Scourge-of-emulation/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49750094> Points: 125 # Comments: 19

Pre-Greek: The lost language hidden within Ancient Greek

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://linguisticdiscovery.com/posts/pre-greek/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49749771> Points: 76 # Comments: 31

A heap overflow and SSO misconfiguration to compromise OpenAI internal repos

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://www.hacktron.ai/blog/hacking-openai> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49749656> Points: 346 # Comments: 140

Shapelearn Qwen 3.8 27B (13.1 GB VRAM)

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://byteshape.com/blogs/Qwen3.8-27B/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49749393> Points: 63 # Comments: 7

Ask A Monk - A digital wilderness for thoughts with no immediate answer

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://askamonk.online> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49749171> Points: 38 # Comments: 23

Telstra outage: The night a network decided the year was 2006

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://www.netnod.se/blog/telstra-outage-night-network-decided-year-was-2006> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49748957> Points: 51 # Comments: 23

Qwen 3.8 Omni Flash

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://qwen.ai/blog?id=qwen3.8-omni-flash> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49747925> Points: 203 # Comments: 75

How to Write with an LLM

Source: *Hacker News (Top 20)*

Article URL: <https://sockpuppet.org/blog/2026/09/17/how-to-write-with-an-llm/>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49747070> Points: 155 #
Comments: 90

How Uber Protects Against Retry Storms

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.uber.com/us/en/blog/protecting-against-retry-storms/>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49746628> Points: 95 #
Comments: 41

Bonsai 2 27B: Near-Lossless Compression in a 9x Smaller Footprint

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://prismml.com/news/bonsai-2-27b> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49746618> Points: 428 # Comments: 126

The most important product decision is what you don't build

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://liamnugent.me/posts/what-you-dont-build/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49746407> Points: 103 # Comments: 36

Show HN: Snapdrop: Instantly share files between devices. No setup, no signup

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://snapdrop.me> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49746346> Points: 73 # Comments: 34

Flet 1.0 - Build cross-platform apps in Python

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://flet.dev/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49746290> Points: 118 # Comments: 54

Bend - A language that blocks AI mistakes via proof, on CPU and GPU

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://bend-lang.com/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49746163> Points: 454 # Comments: 212

Astra for Law

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://openai.com/index/astra-for-law/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49745940> Points: 478 # Comments: 516

Infinite-Parameter LLMs: Generating and Adapting Weights from Live Data

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.18842> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49743483> Points: 143 # Comments: 39

Hister: A private search engine for the pages you visit and the files you keep

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://github.com/asciimoo/hister> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49743097> Points: 600 # Comments: 163

CrowdSec Source Code Leak

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.crowdsec.net/blog/crowdsec-statement-source-code-exposure> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49742355> Points: 151 # Comments: 46